10. Skyline Cranes

Eclipse Cup · upgrade blueprint · src/kart/tracks/cranes.ts

Where it is now

3.1 km on rooftops: low roofs, boosted leap or service bridge, high roofs, gap drop, summit glide or scaffolding. Lap 2 crane loads; last lap gusts.

What is wrong

All on rooftops, but you drive it like a normal road with jumps.

Core mechanic

Moving road. The cranes are part of the road: jibs swing, so the bridge between towers is in a different place each lap. Lift platforms rise and fall, and arriving at the right moment is the skill.

Signature moments

- Drive along a swinging crane jib from one tower to the next.
- A lift platform that carries you up or drops you to a lower roof.
- A girder slide down the side of a building under construction.

Layout changes

- Replace one rooftop gap with a swinging-jib crossing.
- Add a lift between a low and a high roof as a fork.
- Keep the summit glide.

Lap changes

- Lap 2: the cranes swing faster.
- Last lap: wind sways the jibs while you are on them.

Engine work needed

- Moving road pieces that carry the car (jibs, lifts).
- Timing for rivals.

Rivals

- Rivals wait for or time the jib and lift.

Done when

- Laps of 50-60 s for a good driver; all 3-lap test races finish with no errors.
- Rivals use every route and the core mechanic, with no more than 2 rival falls per race.
- The core mechanic is in play for at least half the lap, not just one set piece.
- A blind test: a screenshot or a 10-second clip of this track could not be mistaken for any other track.
- Item rows are never on the start line; nothing solid blocks a road by accident.